

SciVal Strata

SciVal Strata, a web-based modelling tool from Elsevier, allows users to play scientists in teams

Skeletonics

Created by a Japanese team, Skeletonics is a suit that allows extended movements of human appendages.

SECURING TOMORROW

Does PC security really keep people awake at night anymore? What should you worry about? We spoke to the top security businesses to find out...

There are literally millions of threats out in the wild (the net), and all of them are just waiting for you to do something stupid, like click on a banner that offers you a million bucks, or download a file that promises to give you a “free” copy of Windows. However, we’re also well aware that thanks to smarter and more powerful phones and more powerful mobile OSes, there’s a new platform for virus and malware writers to target,



Pankaj Jain, Director, ESS Distribution (P) Ltd

and in India, it’s certainly a much bigger target than the PC user base. Thanks to 3G, many more of us will be browsing on mobile devices. We’ll also be trying out a lot of software on these devices thanks to the skyrocketing app market.

Keeping this in mind, we decided to ask some security vendors about their thoughts on the matter, and whether mobile devices are really the future for their business.

d What is your opinion on free anti-virus software available?

Pankaj Jain

Director, ESS Distribution (P) Ltd

“There are free and illegal versions of antiviruses that are doing the rounds in the market (and online too). When it comes to enterprise solutions, there is a need for complete security solutions that cover gateways, servers and workstations. In fact, according to a survey done by a renowned agency, pirated antivirus software contribute approximately 42 per cent of the market. So there is a significant market share that is still unexplored.”

Jagannath Patnaik

Director – Channel sales, Kaspersky Labs India

“There is always going to be some, who will opt for freewares but the maximum are willing to pay for security software if they are offered at an affordable price without compromising on security and we have priced our products in such a manner that the end user see value for their money.”

d How do you plan to compete against such free alternatives?

Srinivasan S

Senior Vice President – Sales and Marketing, K7 Computing

“Free security programs only provide limited protection. They might scan for malware, and often can perform automatic scans, too. However a paid security suite typically offers comprehensive tools such as parental controls and identity theft protection. Purchased security suites are always intended to



Jagannath Patnaik, Director – Channel sales, Kaspersky Labs India

be a one stop security solution. The biggest challenge one might face if they are using a free version is the non-availability of technical support.”

d Have you noticed any specific trends in recent security attacks?

Pankaj Jain

Director, ESS Distribution (P) Ltd

“Malware is the broader term used for a combination of Trojans, adware, spyware, viruses and worms. You can’t get rid of present day attacks with just signature-based detection techniques. Also, malware incidents have almost doubled compared to last year and stand at approximately 50,000 malware reports per day. Social networking sites such as Facebook and Orkut are also being used extensively to carry



Srinivasan S, Senior Vice President – Sales and Marketing, K7 Computing